

Conflict As Information

45–50 min · January Week 1 · Standard

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish conflict as data from conflict as threat, identify their dominant conflict pattern, and apply the conflict-as-data reframe to one current situation.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness (primary) · Relationship Skills (supporting)
DURATION	45–50 min · January Week 1 · Standard
KEY VOCABULARY	conflict as data · conflict as threat · fight · flight · freeze · fawn · unmet need · values friction
MATERIALS	Journals · Anchor chart · Scenario Cards B4-15A, B4-15B · WS B4-U3-WS1 (Conflict Pattern)
OPENING REVIEW	'Unit 2 ended with the Backpack Audit. Today Unit 3 begins. The question shifts outward: what do I do with the people who have hurt me — and with the people I have hurt? Today: what is conflict actually trying to tell you?'

ANCHOR CHART

WHAT CONFLICT SIGNALS A VALUE HAS BEEN
CROSSED A NEED HAS NOT BEEN
MET A BOUNDARY HAS BEEN
IGNORED A TRUTH NEEDS NAMING

WHAT CONFLICT IS NOT EVIDENCE OF FAILURE SOMETHING TO ALWAYS AVOID
PROOF SOMEONE IS WRONG A THREAT — IT IS INFORMATION

OPENING RITUAL

60–90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Unit 3 begins today. The question turns outward. Not what do I do with the voice inside that judges me — what do I do with the people who have hurt me, and the people I have hurt, without losing myself in either direction? Today we start with the basics: what is conflict actually trying to tell you?' [Post: 'What is the conflict in your life right now trying to tell you — if you listened to it as data?']